

# Identify gaslighting behaviors from bosses and documented response/coping strategies — Action Checklist

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## RECOGNIZE BEHAVIOR PATTERNS

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- ☐ **Notice when your ideas get restated by your boss in meetings and the group responds only to their version — this pattern of idea erasure trains you to stop contributing.:** Notice when your ideas get restated by your boss in meetings and the group responds only to their version — this pattern of idea erasure trains you to stop contributing.
- ☐ **Track moments when your boss presents your hallway suggestions to leadership as if they originated from themselves — this corridor attribution tactic is designed to make you doubt your own contributions.:** Track moments when your boss presents your hallway suggestions to leadership as if they originated from themselves — this corridor attribution tactic is designed to make you doubt your own contributions.
- ☐ **Watch for situations where your specific work gets absorbed into 'team achievements' while your boss claims individual credit — this systematic misattribution is deliberate, not accidental.:** Watch for situations where your specific work gets absorbed into 'team achievements' while your boss claims individual credit — this systematic misattribution is deliberate, not accidental.
- ☐ **Identify instances where your boss rewrites history about who originated an idea and then makes you feel petty for correcting them — this retroactive claiming makes you question your memory.:** Identify instances where your boss rewrites history about who originated an idea and then makes you feel petty for correcting them — this retroactive claiming makes you question your memory.

## DOCUMENT WITHOUT SPIRALING

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- ☐ **Write down exactly what you contributed, when it happened, and who was present — concrete details without editorializing keep your documentation objective and usable for future reference.:** Write down exactly what you contributed, when it happened, and who was present — concrete details without editorializing keep your documentation objective and usable for future reference.
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- **Keep a separate dated record of each incident outside company systems — using personal devices and email protects your documentation from being accessed, deleted, or denied.:** Keep a separate dated record of each incident outside company systems — using personal devices and email protects your documentation from being accessed, deleted, or denied.

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- **Note your emotional state alongside factual details in your records — tracking how you felt helps you recognize patterns of manipulation and self-doubt over time.:** Note your emotional state alongside factual details in your records — tracking how you felt helps you recognize patterns of manipulation and self-doubt over time.

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- **Preserve emails, messages, and files that prove your original contributions existed — digital evidence creates an undeniable paper trail of your actual work.:** Preserve emails, messages, and files that prove your original contributions existed — digital evidence creates an undeniable paper trail of your actual work.

## RESPOND STRATEGICALLY

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- **Practice stating your contribution calmly in low-stakes moments first — rehearsing factual responses like 'as I mentioned in our one-on-one' builds your confidence without appearing territorial.:** Practice stating your contribution calmly in low-stakes moments first — rehearsing factual responses like 'as I mentioned in our one-on-one' builds your confidence without appearing territorial.

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- **Set clear boundaries about what feedback is collaborative versus what is your individual work — having these definitions prevents your boss from retroactively claiming ownership of your ideas.:** Set clear boundaries about what feedback is collaborative versus what is your individual work — having these definitions prevents your boss from retroactively claiming ownership of your ideas.

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- **Decide on your escalation path before you need it — know whether you'll report to HR, your boss's manager, or your professional network so you're not deciding under pressure.:** Decide on your escalation path before you need it — know whether you'll report to HR, your boss's manager, or your professional network so you're not deciding under pressure.

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- **Recognize that fighting every incident will drain you — choose your moments strategically and preserve your energy for behaviors that cross clear lines rather than trying to correct every erasure.:** Recognize that fighting every incident will drain you — choose your moments strategically and preserve your energy for behaviors that cross clear lines rather than trying to correct every erasure.

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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.